

CRM for Residential Plumbing + HVAC + Electrical — Single Customer View, Install Pipeline, Callbacks, Maintenance Plans

Executive summary — Residential home services company, 3 trades (plumbing, HVAC, electrical), 18 techs + 3 office + 2 HVAC sales, Houston suburbs. 4,200 active customers, 300 new leads/month from Google Ads, Angi, referrals. HVAC installs: 25/month at \$8k-15k (margin driver). Plumbing/electrical: \$250-\$600 tickets, high frequency. 600 maintenance plans at \$180/yr with renewal churn due to no follow-up. Current stack: Housecall Pro for dispatch/invoicing, QuickBooks Online for books, spreadsheets for follow-ups. Housecall lacks sales pipeline and cross-trade customer view. Prior attempts: Jobber 6 months 2 years ago (single-trade only), HubSpot free CRM last year (double entry, techs never used). Must-haves: single customer view across 3 trades with equipment/warranty/history, HVAC install pipeline with financing and loss reasons, service ticket view for callbacks/warranty linking to original job, maintenance plan tracking and renewal automation via text/email, field-friendly texting that techs will use. Constraints: keep Housecall as dispatch (CRM addition not replacement), sync with Housecall and QBO without double entry, <\$400/month for 5 office/sales seats, techs via mobile app without seats, hands-on onboarding, migrate 2 years history + 1,100 open estimates, no go-live June-Aug summer peak. Goal in 6 months: one record per customer across trades, installs tracked to lead source with close reasons, callbacks tied to original job with cost, renewal rate 62% to 85%, repeat cross-trade rate up 20%.

The decision

Add a CRM that sits alongside Housecall Pro dispatch and QBO books, delivering single customer view across plumbing/HVAC/electrical, HVAC install pipeline with financing and loss reasons, callback/warranty ticket tracking linked to original job, and maintenance plan renewal automation with texting techs will use — or stay on Housecall + spreadsheets if no CRM meets sync, budget, adoption, and blackout constraints.

Decision maker

Owner-Operator, residential plumbing + HVAC + electrical, 23 people (18 techs, 3 office, 2 sales), Houston suburbs, oversees ops and sales.

Situation

Company runs 3 trades under one brand. Dispatch and invoicing in Housecall Pro, corporate accounting in QBO, sales follow-up in spreadsheets. Customer records exist in Housecall but no sales pipeline — if a plumber sees aging HVAC, no cross-sell is tracked. 4,200 active customers in Housecall, 300 new leads/month (Google Ads, Angi, referrals). HVAC installs are 25/month at \$8k-15k, high margin, require financing and multi-visit quotes. Plumbing and electrical are \$250-\$600, high frequency. 600 maintenance plans at \$180/yr, renewal rate 62% due to manual follow-up. 1,100 open estimates sit in Housecall with no stage tracking. Team: 18 techs in field, 3 office staff doing phones, dispatch, accounting, 2 sales for HVAC replacements. Office staff not tech savvy, techs resistant to extra steps. Lead response time critical — \$12k jobs lost if front desk doesn't follow up in 10 minutes.

Desired outcome

In 6 months: every customer has one record with all 3 trades, equipment, warranty, 2-year history. 25 HVAC installs/month tracked to lead source (Google Ads, Angi, referral) with close reasons, not gut feel. Callbacks tracked to original job with cost, so owner knows which install crew or tech is costing warranty money. Maintenance plan renewal rate from 62% to 85% via automated text/email. Repeat customer rate across trades up 20% because cross-sell plumbing when doing HVAC is finally tracked and prompted.

Prior experience

- Jobber 2 years ago for 6 months — great for single trade plumbing but broke when adding electrical, no multi-trade customer view, left
- HubSpot free CRM last year — techs never used it, double entry with Housecall required switching tabs, office hated it, went back to spreadsheets
- Housecall Pro current — solid for dispatch/invoicing but no sales pipeline, no cross-sell tracking, no callback cost linking, maintenance plan renewal manual

Priorities

- Single customer view across plumbing, HVAC, electrical — history, equipment, warranty, quotes vs sold, lifetime value
- Sales pipeline for HVAC installs with stages, financing, close reasons, lead source attribution
- Service ticket view for callbacks and warranty linked to original job with cost tracking
- Maintenance plan tracking — expiration, owner, renewal automation via text/email
- Field-friendly texting that techs will actually use from mobile, without needing paid seats
- No double entry — must sync with Housecall Pro and QBO

Constraints

- Budget under \$400/month all-in for 5 office/sales seats, techs via mobile app without seats
- Keep Housecall Pro as dispatch — this is CRM addition, not dispatch replacement, cannot disrupt dispatch
- Must sync with Housecall Pro and QuickBooks Online without double entry — if manual entry required, adoption fails
- Migrate 2 years customer history, equipment, and 1,100 open estimates from Housecall
- Hands-on onboarding required — office not tech savvy, cannot do self-serve videos and 3-month implementation
- Blackout: no go-live June-August — HVAC install peak season, risk of losing jobs if systems break
- Team of 23, 18 techs resistant to extra steps

Options considered

- Do nothing / Keep Housecall Pro + QBO + spreadsheets despite cross-sell invisibility and renewal churn
- Add lightweight CRM that sits on Housecall — Jobber CRM add-on, Housecall Pro CRM power-ups, or trade-specific CRM like ServiceTitan CRM module
- Add general CRM with Housecall integration — HubSpot Starter with Housecall via Zapier, or Zoho CRM with custom integration
- Switch dispatch + CRM to all-in-one ServiceTitan or Housecall Pro Max with stronger CRM, accepting higher cost and retraining

Tradeoffs

- Staying on Housecall + spreadsheets avoids migration and tech resistance but continues cross-sell invisibility, \$12k lead loss if no 10-min follow-up, and 62% renewal rate
- Lightweight CRM that sits on Housecall has lower migration risk and techs stay in Housecall, but may lack true install pipeline with financing and loss reasons and callback cost linking
- General CRM like HubSpot gives strong pipeline and lead source tracking and Google Ads auto-flow but creates double entry risk with Housecall and techs already rejected it once for switching tabs

- All-in-one ServiceTitan gives single system for dispatch + CRM + maintenance plans but is highest cost, requires retraining 18 techs, and risks summer peak disruption June-Aug — violates blackout
- Automated renewal texting helps hit 85% renewal but if techs don't use CRM to close loop, renewal automation sends to wrong customers

Risks and concerns

- Techs won't use CRM — they already hate Housecall notes, adding steps means CRM ignored in field
- Callback cost leakage — can't link warranty return to original job, eating cost without knowing which crew/tech is burning money
- Lead response failure — Google Ads leads don't auto-flow into CRM, front desk forgets 10-min follow-up, lose \$12k HVAC jobs
- Double entry creeping back if Housecall and QBO sync breaks after CRM added — same failure that killed HubSpot attempt
- Summer peak disruption if go-live hits June-August — install season, cannot risk dispatch breakage

Unknowns

- Which CRM actually delivers Housecall Pro + QBO sync without double entry for 3-trade view at 4,200 customers?
- Will techs use mobile texting from CRM or continue personal phone texts losing history?
- Exact migration mapping for 2 years history and 1,100 open estimates from Housecall to CRM?
- Hands-on onboarding included in <\$400/mo or extra cost, and timeline to avoid June-Aug?
- Callback linking — does CRM allow linking warranty ticket to original install job and showing cost for crew performance?

Decision criteria

- Single customer record across plumbing, HVAC, electrical with equipment, warranty, 2-year history
- HVAC install pipeline with stages, financing, lead source, close reasons
- Callback/warranty ticket linked to original job with cost tracking for crew/tech performance
- Maintenance plan tracking with expiration, owner, renewal automation via text/email
- Field-friendly texting via mobile that techs will actually use, without requiring paid tech seats
- Reliable sync with Housecall Pro and QBO without double entry
- Total cost under \$400/month for 5 seats with hands-on onboarding and 2-year + 1,100 estimates migration, avoiding June-Aug go-live

Next steps

1. Export Housecall Pro full customer list, equipment, 2-year jobs, 1,100 open estimates, maintenance plans to assess migration complexity
2. Shortlist 3 CRMs: one trade-native that sits on Housecall (ServiceTitan CRM, Housecall Pro Max), one general with Housecall Zapier (HubSpot Starter, Zoho), and one mid-market field service CRM with strong mobile texting
3. Demo script: Google Ads lead auto-flows in, front desk assigns in 10 mins, plumber notes aging HVAC, cross-sell task created, sales closes HVAC install with financing and loss reason, callback links to original job with cost, maintenance renewal text sent, owner sees per-trade repeat rate

4. Ask each vendor: Housecall + QBO sync failure rate, mobile texting adoption by techs, maintenance plan renewal automation rate, migration of 1,100 estimates, onboarding included vs extra, June-Aug blackout support
5. Run September parallel with one office user and one sales user tracking 25 installs to validate lead source and close reasons before full rollout avoiding summer peak

Recommendation

Do not switch dispatch. Add a CRM that proves Housecall Pro + QBO sync without double entry, field texting techs will use, and maintenance renewal automation in a September parallel tracking 25 installs with lead source and close reasons, with 2-year history and 1,100 estimates migration validated and hands-on onboarding included under \$400/mo. If no CRM passes field adoption and callback linking demo, stay on Housecall + spreadsheets and hire part-time follow-up coordinator to manually push renewal rate from 62% toward 85% while re-evaluating after summer peak.

This Decision Brief reflects information provided during the interview. It does not independently verify external facts. Artifact: HTML shown on screen after \$9 payment + Save as PDF, same brief in two forms, no free preview.

Generated: 2026-05-14 • Anonymous session • No login • No database • Server memory only • Session discarded